

School Committee Meeting Notes - September 9, 2020 - 4:30 PM - via Zoom

Mayor calls meeting to order - 4:33 PM

Roll Call / Salute the Flag - 7-0

Motion to suspend the rules - by Member Kreatz, seconded by Member Van der Kloot & Graham

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - Going into executive session 4:38 PM

Mayor - We have reverted back to the regular meeting now at 6:13 PM

Mayor - Motion to approve minutes of August 17th meeting?

Motion to table by Member Ruseau, seconded by Member Graham

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 meeting notes tabled

Mayor - Motion to approve Bills, transfers, etc?

Motion to approve by Member Van der Kloot

Member Graham - charge for Guardian Management Solutions - what is that for?

Mr. Murphy - I don't have that, but I'll get it for you

Member Graham - Arctic Engineering -

Mr. Murphy - I believe it's routine maintenance, but we double check and email you the information shortly

Member Ruseau - What about the bill from Viking?

Mr. Murphy - I'll check with Mr. Paquette

Mayor - Motion for approval on table, seconded by Member Kreatz

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - Bill are passed, with understanding that Mr. Murphy will email us with information/explanations requested.

Mayor Report of Secretary

Member Van der Kloot - no warrant this week - Just a point of information as Chair of curriculum subcommittee, we plan to meet after school begins at some point to discuss the disability awareness curriculum

Mayor - Report of Committees - Special Meeting & Committee of the Whole notes - Motion for approval?

Motion to table by Member Graham, seconded by Member Ruseau

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - paper is tabled

Mayor - Community participation - Welcome Ms. Susan Sheehan

Susan Sheehan - I am one of 63% for hybrid choice - I'd like my children to go back full time - that option doesn't seem to be on the table - SC and Admin is prioritizing the teachers union vs the students - you are paid to represent us - education has to be in the best interest of the students, not the teachers - Public should be given a summary of teacher's union demands - details shouldn't be confidential - affects livelihoods of so many in the community - motion be brought that the teachers contract should be posted to the website - why are you letting teachers work from home at all? Teachers should be in the classroom - minimal exposure in Medford - Hybrid needs to be the focus of this group - concerns about pushing the teachers too hard - we should take a stronger stance - Pg 7 of remote learning guide - hybrid as soon as possible - it is feasible now - someone on the committee that we return to hybrid learning on Sept 19th - Finally, on accountability - ultimately the teachers will be held accountable for what's going on with the union - you should voice your opinion - negative and lasting impact on the education of the children of Medford - teacher evaluations should be heightened at this time - we don't want a repeat of what happened in the Spring - focus on the needs of the kids and get them the education they are looking for - no schedules for kids or teacher assignments and school starts in a week - adopt a more, Kids first mentality -

Mayor - other speakers? You will have 2 minutes

Mr. Beagan - I want to thank Susan for speaking today - I do share her concerns - currently the decision is all remote - we know kids won't thrive in this environment - wait and see attitude will

not benefit kids - SC should be as honest and frank with parents as possible - I don't want to hear, when it is safe. We need answers

Mr. Giglio - Promotion of rally by Member McLaughlin - could hinder going back to school

Member McLaughlin - It's outside, masked and a short time with hand sanitizer - I'm not sure how the rally has anything to do with going back to school - the rally is not involved with MPS or City Hall. Student organizing it is a friend of one of my children

Mr. Carbone - Kids should be going back to school - kids are being harmed by not going back - you are actively hurting our children by not going back to school - you have to answer the question - we told you what we wanted - SC needs to do their job and bring the students back to school

Mayor - Is Mr. Greenspan on the call? Next Wednesday, we will have most of the testing back and we will be able to give more information - if schools are testing well, we need to get our students back

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - thank you to all who expressed your concerns - we are in ongoing negotiations plus awaiting HVAC reports - Sept 14-17th - addressing Air quality and HVAC - We may results by our next meeting so we will know the state of HVAC and air quality in all of our buildings - and then we can set a return of staggered hybrid for our students My goal is before Oct - almost every school district in similar situation -

Member McLaughlin - appreciate the public participation - I want to assure Ms. Sheehan, we are prioritizing children - we have lost a lot of sleep with our children coming back to school - please do not demonize teachers - they have families too -

Member Van der Kloot - we aren't alone, it's a much bigger issue - we are all trying to figure this out

Member Graham - I echo what my colleagues have said - in a situation such as this, it looks like there are sides - We are all committed to get our students back to school - I want to do it safely - My sister teaches in another state. In school lasted in her district (2) days and now they are remote - I don't want to see that happen here - we have to communicate better -

Member Graham - I would like to make a motion that all of our union contracts are posted on our website, as they are public record, they are very complex - by 12/31/2020, seconded by Member McLaughlin - by 12/31/2020

Mayor - Would this be considered a public records request for union contracts?

Mr. Murphy - a copy of CBA's can be made available - time will be needed to make them more readable - but we will respond as quickly as we can

Member Ruseau - this has been the 2nd time it has been asked to be placed on the website, now this is the 3rd request

Mr. Murphy - we will do that as soon as possible

Mayor - Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - motion passes

Mayor - Report of the Superintendent

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We are (1) week out from beginning the 2020-2021 school year remotely. We have worked diligently with the teachers, paras, staff, unions and administrators, to provide the best education possible during this uncertain time. It is my hope that, come October, we will be able to begin to welcome students gradually back into the buildings for in person learning, for that is truly our goal and the best situation for all students to be able to learn successfully. Meet and greets, although brief due to covid regulations, will provide students with the opportunity to meet their teacher, access schedules, textbooks and chromebooks and see their classmates at a distance. The meet and greets will be held next Monday, September 14th and next Tuesday, September 15th. Please consult with your building principal for time and particulars. I would like to take this opportunity to congratulate Marie Cassidy and the Medford Family Network on their selection for a grant from the Cambridge Community Foundation, in the amount of \$10,000. The MFN is looked upon as a leader in the regional effort to address the current COVID -19 pandemic. As the Mayor noted last week, we are hopeful that all Medford families will complete the 2020 Census. Information provided on the census is completely confidential and is used to make sure that we receive the appropriate funding for our school lunch program and other critical resources. The deadline is September 30th. Toni Wray and the Medford School Nurses have released two important reminders which are available on our website and blog: The Importance of Wearing a Face Mask, as well as, the new State Mandate about Flu Shots. All students will be required to receive one this year. Lastly, I am sure we all remember where we were on Friday, September 11, 2001. This Friday, is the 19th Anniversary of the Terrorist Attacks. As a Boston College graduate, I remember seeing the story of the "The Man in the Red Bandana" on ESPN. Welles Crowther, a BC grad, saved a number of people on that terrible day. Unfortunately, Welles did not survive. It was a terrible time in our history. Today, we are in the midst of another awful crisis in our country, the pandemic. However, after

the 9/11 attacks, Americans came together...regardless of skin color, religion, creed or sexual orientation. They came together with a unity of purpose and a shared belief of citizens giving back and sacrificing in the name of liberty. I truly hope we can once again, come together, and work for equality, tolerance, safety and fairness for all. And for all those lost on 9/11, I would ask that we observe a moment of silence in their memory. Thank you and may they Rest in Peace.

Mayor - Thank you Madam Superintendent. Now for the Covid update from MaryAnn O'Connor and Toni Wray

Ms. O'Connor - Medford is still considered in the yellow - 5.4 % an increase in cases from last week - we have been back and forth with DPH - when you are deemed positive, it will be on the date you were diagnosed - map is a 14 day incident date, but it's rolling data - What are the metrics? Well, we don't want to be at 5% , I would like to stay at a 3%. There is an increasing possibility of a spread with Medford at 5% and going back to school - the map has been confusing with DPH - Data does get confusing

Mayor - thank you Ms. O'Connor - we appreciate you being here

Ms. Wray - school nurses have been busy in the buildings, posting a lot of relevant safety information, making sure masks are available for all and arranging a schedule for flu shots - Covid training is being implemented for all staff and will be supplemented by the nurses when we return to in person learning - PPE have arrived, so we will distribute throughout all the buildings.

Ms. O'Connor - we are working with DPH - for additional flu shots - we are thinking of arranging a family clinic drive up - we will work with Toni to establish school drive up clinics if we can arrange it

Mayor - Tufts and BOH worked hard to provide testing for our staff when we return to school

Member Ruseau - I have lots of questions - here is the map - and should we be open or not? There has to be an algorithm - it can't be an opinion - I realize it is no one's fault

Ms. O'Connor - you aren't the only school committee struggling with this - we have asked DPH for a positivity rate - DESE states Governor's data, which is the color coded map is what to use - we do need to agree on data and put it out there for everyone to see - DESE hasn't been helpful, because they are sticking by the Governor's data

Member Ruseau - do we look at data daily?

Ms. O'Connor- every (2) weeks, positivity rate is more reliable that way- I would be happy to sit down and establish metrics

Member Ruseau - Way too much ambiguity - no answers

Ms. O'Connor - you are 100% right, but we have Tufts students now - that could add to our counts - if we go back into school and there is a positive case within a cohort that might be it, or it could travel and that school might need to be shut down - every case is different

Member Ruseau - Wait, the School Committee doesn't have authority to close the schools?

Ms. Wray - DESE has final approval

Member Ruseau - this is crazy - DESE should provide metrics

Ms. O'Connor - I'm sure DESE would go along with whatever we decided

Member Graham - DESE will not save us - I would love to work with you MaryAnn - we should publish a dashboard of how we will answer the questions - this is how It will look, if we go to hybrid, or go to full in person, or close the schools - I'm happy to be part of the solution - we have to do this, and can't delay anymore

Mr. Beagan - Yes, what Mr. Ruseau and Ms. Graham are saying is exactly what I'm talking about - metrics should decide - elected officials have to be comfortable with X and if we meet X, then we open schools

Mayor - If there are no further questions, Ms. Wray will explain the Alpha Med App

Ms. Wray - Alpha Med App - Covid Care - determines if student/staff can attend school in good health - platform is HIPPA compliant and completely confidential - Is it mandatory to complete screening daily - we are asking that MPS uses it safely and continuously - Opt out procedure - please email me at twray@medford.k12.ma.us

Member Ruseau - very happy with the App - but I am looking for the holes - I'm all for this - I want to make it mandatory -

Member Graham - I think making it mandatory is a matter of policy - and that is within our realm.

Member Graham - I make a motion, that next week the administration bring us a policy recommendation and operations plan and until then we do not encourage people to email Ms. Wray, seconded by Member Ruseau

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - motion passes

Mr. Murphy - Can you please clarify that motion?

Mayor - Administration establish a policy and make a recommendation to the school committee next week regarding the App.

Mr. Murphy - but I'd like Toni to get the app out there and have people sign up

Member Graham - I have a problem with the Opt out plan

Mr. Murphy - It is an open question whether is mandatory or not - I think we should go forward with signing up people on the App

Member Ruseau - How it's communicated out is very important - don't show our hand in making it mandatory or not

Mr. Murphy - the utilization of this app is completely contingent on people signing up and being honest and utilizing it every day - an additional important resource we will use to keep the schools as safe as possible

Member Graham - Thank you Dave -you are right -

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Welcome Mr. Craig Drauschke as the interim principal for Curtis Tufts High School - we look forward to our continued partnership - thank you for becoming a part of our administrative team

Mr. Drauschke - Thank you for the opportunity and I'm very excited to take on this new task

Member McLaughlin - Congratulations and welcome aboard - you were so fun at the Summer Fun Camp, you included every child - I appreciate your commitment to inclusion, all abilities and equity - you'll be missed by the students at MHS

Mayor - Budget update

Mr. Murphy - Mr. Parquette and I have been working collaboratively until we can appoint a comptroller - several questions on specific line items prior to my arrival - operational audit and business manager - reconstruct the FY 21 budget - no drastic changes - working through the various funding sources subsequent to the budget passing

FYI Update on Bill Explanations:

Arctic Engineering - maintenance for McGlynn & Andrews

Viking - work done at LoConte Rink - painting the ice

District wide science materials

LED light upgrades at McGlynn

Budget is on schedule where we thought we'd be at this point, this year

(3) Covid related funding sources plus (2) other infusions of monies for the budget - allocated by Medford Council - 1st is the \$1.1 M in additional Ch 70 monies - separation of funding operating expenses and capital expenditures - \$860,000 for capital projects at MHS

\$1.1 M - Ch 70 - staffing related - recalling of instructional support staff - \$3,000 for diversity planning materials - additional staff in health positions - given where we are in the hiring season, we are reserving the rest for additional staffing positions - Priority list to best utilize these funds
Capital expenditures - \$860,000 from council last night - approx \$560,000 of mitigation strategies, especially at MHS, and air quality across district - MPS has no evidence to date, that any of the schools are unsafe - \$250,000 if we have to do additional air quality testing at other schools

Member Van der Kloot - Are any grants that we normally receive ... have any dried up or we aren't getting anymore?

Mr. Murphy - No shortfalls on Title 1 grants or any entitlement grants - revolving accounts are our question marks

Mr. Parquette - Committed funds are known and solid

Member Van der Kloot - has FY 20 been closed out?

Mr. Parquette - Yes

Member Van der Kloot - what's the bottom line regarding the status of revolving accounts?
Could we have that at some point?

Mr. Murphy - Yes

Member Ruseau - with all the devices we will be utilizing - won't our electric bills be much higher?

Mr. Murphy - Yes, great point -

Member Graham - What is the Zoom status?

Mr. Murphy - we are actively looking into that

Mayor - Thank you Mr. Murphy and Mr. Parquette. Dr. Kathy Kay is with us from the Columbus School regarding a donation.

Dr. Kay - Thank you. We are in receipt of an extremely generous donation which was sent anonymously in the hopes of helping our families during the Covid pandemic

Motion to approve by Member Van der Kloot, seconded by Member Kreatz

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - donation is approved

Member Ruseau - thank you so much to whomever made the donation - it's wonderful - maybe Dr. Kay can let us know how the money is spent

Dr. Kay - Yes. I will be meeting with our teachers and stakeholders to come a decision of how this will be both useful and sustainable. Thank you for the approval

Mayor - Thank you Dr. Kay. Now Ms. Laden will update us on our technology status

Ms. Laden - As you are aware, we have been able to increase our technology investments through a variety of Covid financial resources - We have purchased 50 hotspots - online library resources to support all classrooms/all grades - purchasing 1300 devices for MHS to go 1-1 - the hotspots are ready to go - we are awaiting the arrival of the chromebooks. Additionally, we received a grant of \$86,000 from DESE which I had hoped to earmark for tablets for our younger students, but tablets are on a long backorder. I ordered assistive technology for students with special needs - Covid Reopening grant - will be providing MACbooks for all of our teachers

with adapters that will work with the projectors in their classrooms - teacher's chrome books will go to the paras - Additionally, it is allowing us to update our bandwidth and that will help us a lot especially at MHS and allow us to manage our mobile devices - filtering system in our chromebooks which is inside the buildings - Lexia - Emergency funding through city= 50 chromebooks - all of this is quite a significant investment

Member Graham - I'm really excited to use money to equip our teachers with real laptops/equipment - it will support them better than a chromebook

Member Ruseau - Do we have enough hotspots available?

Ms. Laden - We are going through data for those in need of hotspots - We have heard from families who do not seem to have reliable internet - Additionally, TMobile has a program for no cost for internet. Regarding our devices update - started with 2000 for distribution - not everything came back and some came back and aren't functioning - elementary kept theirs - as of today we have 1300 device requests - we haven't exceeded the devices as yet - don't have a date for the delivery of new devices

Member Van der Kloot - Thank you for all of your work - how long does it take a new device to get up and running? Will you have enough staff?

Ms. Laden - for chromebooks it's quick, just a lot of them to do. Mobile devices are different - I hope they don't arrive at same time - but we'll do what we have to do

Marsha Kirece - tech surveys - what about students in the system who haven't responded to the survey? Or who receives free and reduced lunch who might need a hotspot?

Ms. Laden - people can go into the schools for meet and greets & devices and hotspots will be available - teachers/principals will find out and refer to me

Mayor - Thank you Molly for this report. Recommendation to approve draft of the School Committee Calendar for the 2020-2021 School Year

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I do have one request that we change the October 19th meeting to October 26th, as we have a conflict

Mayor - And additional meetings can be scheduled as needed.

Member Mustone - Motion to approve, seconded by Member Ruseau.

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I would ask that the Committee consider hosting our next meeting in the Council Chamber as the Council did last Tuesday.

Mayor - Is there a motion to move our next meeting into the Council Chamber?

Member Van der Kloot - I couldn't see all the members except President Falco - there is an advantage to the zoom meetings right now

Mayor - Patrick Gordon did work on it for an entire day - that is a hybrid system

Member Van der Kloot - I found the zoom part terrific - but they couldn't see each other - I'm willing to try it - I can see people participate via zoom - attendance is great - you can do both -

Member McLaughlin - very difficult not seeing the Councillors faces - we have to consider close captioning - discussion of wearing masks in chamber - How are we making it accessible for those who are hard of hearing & we are wearing masks?

Member Van der Kloot - Can we just zoom in on our next meeting?

Mayor - we will discuss the concerns raised with Mr. Gordon

Member Ruseau - I'm confused - why would we want to go into the Chamber? - this is better set up - so much better participation - I won't vote to go back

Mayor - public wants us back - send me your concerns so I can discuss with Mr. Gordon

Member Graham - i think it's unfair that the public wants us back - to paint this as a single voice is untrue - my priority is to get kids back to school and the rest of us should stay home so our kids can get back to school -

Member Graham - I would like to add an amendment to the Calendar motion to schedule an additional meeting for subcommittee meeting scheduling

Member McLaughlin - I appreciate that Member Graham - the Behavioral Health & Special Education Subcommittee have already scheduled their meetings

Member Kreatz - I did watch the Council meeting last night - would we have a hybrid plan if some of the members wanted to zoom or sit in the chamber?

Mayor - that part could be decided by this body - public meetings are happening in the Chamber
- some can't access zoom

Member Ruseau - to be fair, the school committee and virtually every parent is a stakeholder, the pandemic has offered us the option of zoom and still parents etc can participate - 35 people would show up at city hall, while over 100 people are on our zoom meetings - we shouldn't pick for the 35 people

Mayor - I don't think zoom is going away

Mayor - Roll Call for Calendar with amendment from Member Graham -

Member Graham - can we pick a date?

Mayor - can we do it as a committee of the whole?

Member Graham - I'd rather do it as a separate meeting

Member Graham - could we do Sept 21st?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - 4:30?

Mayor - Roll Call Vote, adding September 21st

Member Van der Kloot - Can we start at 4:45 PM instead?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Yes.

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - motion passes

Mayor - Dr. Cushing and Mr. Maloney will present report on athletics

Dr. Cushing - Report on athletics is presented with guidance of DESE, MIAA and Executive Office of Environmental Affairs - our usual 3 season format will be broken up into a 4 season format for this year.

Mr. Maloney - MIAA has decided to add a 4th season - so February to April will be the "fall" sports season - I'm not happy with the plan - we meet tomorrow as a league - 2 of our schools are in the red zone, so they cannot participate - Medford wants to play in the fall - athletics is

instrumental in the development of the whole child - if they don't participate with us, they'll participate elsewhere - if we don't have a league to participate in - we can run an extensive intramural program in the fall, with the approval of the school committee

Dr. Cushing - Football and cheer are considered high risk - significant restrictions have been placed on soccer which seem to have a substantial impact on the game - the priority of GBL is on safety - my concern is our major snowstorms lately have occurred in February and March, so I'm unsure of how that 4th season will start. Also due to budget limitations, we eliminated freshmen athletics, but the pandemic kind of ended that conversation - Middle school athletics do not have much interest at this point

Mr. Maloney - it is up to the school committee to authorize athletics/conditioning for our athletes,

Mayor - if Malden, Everett and Revere couldn't participate - could we have conditioning and scrimmages?

Mr. Maloney - you have to understand that every season is important - so would we have 16 sports in the spring!

Mayor - just to get the kids with their peers, practicing and scrimmages would be great

Member McLaughlin - freshmen sports - now we have received money since the budget was set - a lot of incoming freshmen who need a sense of structure and team - where do we stand? I have to abstain from vote as my son is a captain of soccer

Mr. Maloney - we have to look at the numbers - very few freshmen sports last year - we could expand JV teams, or have a no cut policy

Member McLaughlin - thank you

Mayor - yes, let's see what our enrollment numbers are

Member Van der Kloot - No reason to abstain Melanie - you can vote - we have got some money back - so if there is a way to include freshmen that would be great - is this the 1st year that the Thanksgiving game won't be played?

Mr. Maloney - I think during one of the World Wars, the Thanksgiving Game was not played

Member Graham - Regarding Fall sports 1 - how do we pay for a double season? Where are we getting the money for it?

Mr. Maloney - we won't ask you for more money to make it happen

Member Graham - who will be responsible for compliance such as social distancing etc, spectators, group photos? How can we prevent sports from providing a spike in cases and then we'd have to go remote?

Mr. Maloney - Our athletic trainer will drill the coaching staff. If program is abused, we would pull the plug - we have great facilities - big enough to spread out so that will help tremendously - I don't anticipate a problem

Member Graham - Do we have a document that all athletes would sign off on who want to participate?

Mr. Maloney - We will update the current policy & approve it through the Superintendent

Member Graham - I don't want to be the next Windham NH, due to fall athletics
We need to do this safely and include our freshmen.

Member Ruseau - Is there busing involved ? Just something to think about

Mr. Maloney - no buses with conditioning - if City decides to scrimmage or play a game - we would look to have people come here, as our facilities are large and excellent

Member Graham - I make a motion to authorize a plan - freshmen will participate in fall conditioning and updated policy for athletes to compete and have school committee approve the plan, before fall sports starts, seconded by Ms. Kreatz

Roll Call Vote -7-0 - motion passes

Mayor - Ms. Galusi & Mr. Milaschewski will present [2020-2021 MPS Reopening Update](#)

Ms. Galusi - thank you for working with us

Mr. Milaschewski - Our Core values - safety, equity, and consistency:

Remote starts Sept 16th Grades 1-12 / Sept 21st for Kindergarten

Equity - Most vulnerable students to begin in person Sept 28th

Consistency - Staggered hybrid model - 65% of families have opted with 35% selecting full remote - trying to limit transition for students

We are in the process of matching staff with what families want

Ms. Galusi - The upcoming week: class schedule & teacher assignments, families meet and greet, Families gain access to Family/Caregiver Remote Resources & Families receive MPS Language of expectations for Remote Learning

Member McLaughlin - any updates from Joan about the most vulnerable going back to school? Have parents been notified of the September 28th start date?

Ms. Galusi - I'd have to check with Joan

Mr. Murphy - If I could jump in here - only the administration has utilized this date - this is probably the earliest possible date, but negotiations are ongoing - so we don't want to provide conflicting information until we are positive this is the date

Ms. Castignetti - clarification for most vulnerable students - Kindergarten, EL ?

Mr. Milaschewski - I can share the screen and maybe Ms. Bowen can join us. This is who MPS adopted as our Most Vulnerable - IEP & homeless, but we added homeless and foster care, despite IEP, as well as, Newcomers Level 1 and 2

Member McLaughlin - just to clarify - the 28th is the best laid plans for high needs - those students would hopefully start on the 28th - no one notified yet, due to negotiations

Mr. Murphy - Yes - there are still questions about staffing - operationally we need to move toward a date - but it is not set in stone - we are planning for our most vulnerable to be in school on September 28th

Member McLaughlin - Could Ms. Bowen be placed on the agenda for the next meeting please? And Mr. Teixeira as well?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Yes, we can do that

Mayor - any old business? Hearing and seeing none, I'll move over to communications. Hearing and seeing none. I'll move to the Good of the Order offered by Member McLaughlin

Member McLaughlin - generally the school committee is required is to do self evaluation/ analysis of how we are doing as a committee - we should do an evaluation by December, to see how effectively we have been working - again recommended through Robert's Rules of Order - I've witnessed some dysfunction amongst other elected bodies

Member Ruseau - we aren't full time legislators - no staff to respond back to our emails for example

Member McLaughlin - I would like to think about some professional development. How are we working as a team? This will be a monthly agenda item - so I appreciate your feedback

Member Kreatz - I'd really like to reduce the hours of the meetings. We need to respect everyone's schedules. The meetings are so long it's hard to retain it all . Hard to sometimes function the next day at work.

Member McLaughlin - these 8-10 hour meetings are far too long - maybe we need to meet more regularly like the Council does? But we will have the Good of the Order at the beginning of October

Mayor - Thank you Member McLaughlin - You are now presenting stakeholder engagement

Member McLaughlin - Thank you. I feel people are probably roundtabled out at this point, so I'll take it off the agenda

Mayor - we will try for less hours

Mayor - Member McLaughlin's Resolution regarding the operating budget

Member McLaughlin - I would amend it to December 31, 2020 - a lot of confusion over past budgets - I'm requesting a narrative for the next budget process/flow chart - available to the public and the school committee.

Mayor - Yes, that can be handled between the attorneys and the Assistant Superintendent of Finance.

Mayor - Member McLaughlin's motion is seconded by Member Van der Kloot

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - motion passes

Mayor - Member Ruseau's Resolution regarding discipline

Member Ruseau - It's really self explanatory - I could have sent it to subcommittee, but rather, if we approve tonight, the Superintendent can make the necessary changes or suggestions, and make it a work in progress - I make motion to approve

Member Van der Kloot - could the Superintendent comment please? Does this work for you?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I understand the spirit this was presented - I believe in restorative justice - but to make a blanket statement, no out of school suspension - I think we have to re look at the wording - there are many extenuating circumstances where out of school suspension is warranted - looking at our data, we can make changes as needed with discipline at MHS - I would like to have further discussion and bring it to subcommittee. But for 2020-2021 school year, to approve no out of school suspension, that is not appropriate

Member Kreatz - Thank you for the resolution - I believe in restorative justice as well and hope this could be discussed in the Rules subcommittee

Dr. Cushing - 4 specific areas under the law for emergency student removal - assault of staff member, drugs/alcohol on student, student felony - Restorative justice training for teachers - would reduce suspensions - We must maintain the statutory and legal supports for schools for egregious behavior occurs Suspension should be the last resort

Member Ruseau - no policy of the school committee negates the law - I do need to point out black students are getting suspended 2.8 times over white students When is the right time? It's never going to be the right time I have no interest in sending to subcommittee

Member Van der Kloot - as I read it and taking into account what everyone has said, we should add, except in accordance with the law, into the resolution. I don't have a problem meeting in subcommittee

Mayor - I think we need more time to debate it

Motion to move to subcommittee by Member Van der Kloot, seconded by Member Kreatz

Mayor - let us hear from the public before voting

Maria Rodrigues - you have to look at how discipline is administered in the middle schools. It's well known that white students get away with stuff the black kids do not

Nadine Marette - It pains me when the children might not even be in school - I just don't understand the importance of this resolution at this time

Cheryl - I wanted to mirror what the Superintendent said - suspensions are used only in serious cases

Veronica Hernandez - I was suspended for chewing gum - I am a black student - I absolutely think Paul's resolution is important - I think it should be looked into as to why students are being suspended

Roll Call Vote - 4 in the affirmative, 3 in the negative - motion passes

Member Ruseau - Okay then, I'd like to schedule the Rules Subcommittee for next Tuesday, September 15th at 6 PM

Mayor - Member Graham's resolution regarding technology issues

Member Graham - dropping own personal connections with chromebooks - houseful of devices with no issues - we need to prepare for remote learning - what's the cause of this? I don't want this to become an equity issue - I'm hoping the tech dept can address this and it should happen before we begin remote learning Tip sheet should go onto the website, seconded by Member Ruseau - also, do we have a phone number for tech support and if we don't we should

Mr. Murphy - we don't have that - it is something we'll have to work on

Member Van der Kloot - We just heard Molly's report - I'm concerned with the deadline being September 14th - I really think we need to focus on reopening the schools - could Ms. Laden address this?

Ms. Laden - The tech support requests have only been a handful of people - not a large number - what goes on in someone's home is hard to assess - chromebook is a less expensive device - if a device doesn't work, we can replace it - it is just a matter of what we can do with what we have - a lot of people aren't having the issue - but we have a number of limitations - and we can now provide hotspots - some people have might have unreliable internet - you've seen it during this

very meeting. That is up to their internet provider. We have looked at this across the state amongst my fellow colleagues.

Member Graham - we don't give unsharpened pencils to students - there was no place to call for help to try to figure the problem, to stem the chaos - I don't think that's too much to ask - can we just try to make it a little bit easier - but telling everyone to call Molly shouldn't be the answer - Although I did send questions to Molly on August 27th.

Ms. Laden - Questions can be sent to the tech support email - requests are varied - you did send the screenshots to me - we addressed ones over the Spring - a lot of those were issues out of our control

Member Graham - how fast do I get a response?

Member Kreatz - I'm concerned about the connectivity and I'm concerned about Molly working overtime - I think the time frame is too short - I would like to amend it & have people send questions to the email address and get responses as fast as possible. I've worked remotely since covid, and I've had issues, and my IT dept said to contact my internet provider

Mr. Murphy - We can provide a report on the problems with the chromebooks and put together and then have posted a family tip sheet

Member Graham - yes, as long as you provide a root cause

Mr. Murphy - But we need to get tech into their hands right now - we will want the Family Tip Sheet generated within the next week - the report can wait until later in the month

Mayor - great compromise

Member Van der Kloot - I concur - Tip sheet is a great idea - I would ask Molly to look at what Member Graham gave you and if you can reach out to those families if possible - I don't know if Member Graham would be willing to amend her motion?

Member Graham - someone needs to call these families - can teachers run their programs on a browser?- I want those families reached out to, and we need a person on a line, for questions if someone gets bounced out of a zoom

Mr. Murphy - we agree for the need for responsiveness - We will have a tip sheet ready within the week - we appreciate your patience

Member McLaughlin - Yes, a tip sheet is really important - I'm confused - I thought we had requested that webinars/PD for families would be provided to them from the schools? Has that been scheduled?

Mayor - Yes, Tom and Suzanne provided the links for the website

Ms. Galusi- slide presentations and videos and once school starts, we will provide live coaching classes, and we already began a Tip sheet

Member McLaughlin - how are we providing this information with our non english speaking families?

Ms. Galusi - we have been in discussion with Paul Texiera - translations can happen concurrently while lesson is being taught

Ms. Castignetti - We have a wonderful tech teacher at McGlynn School, Portuguese speaking, gave them assistance - she is more than willing to host a class for parents, but I'll defer to Mr. Teixiera.

Mr. Teixiera - she has her own website in Portuguese - once it's fully developed, we will make it accessible to other languages

Ms. Galusi - Ms. Schulman's items have all been translated

Member Ruseau - can you re read the resolution

Mayor - Tip Sheet before September 16th - and report due last day in September

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - motion passes

Member Graham - acceptable use policy for K-5 includes photo releases - the SC voted on this in 2019 - I just can't fathom that's true - both policies need to be reviewed - I make a motion that this is sent to Rules subcommittee and to revise this policy immediately accepting photo release in exchange for use of a chromebook - We need to pass this tonight, seconded by Member Ruseau

Member Van der Kloot - I am willing to strike the piece - but then rest should go to the Rules subcommittee as I'm just seeing it tonight - another option is to put it on the agenda for our next meeting so we can all look at it

Member Graham - Okay, but I only changed 7 words

Member Van der Kloot - I feel close to brain dead

Mayor - this is good Jenny, but I'm feeling the same as Paulette

Member Van der Kloot - I would amend Jenny's motion and put on agenda for next week, and not finalize it tonight

Member Kreatz - we need to send this to the policy subcommittee - students need to get their chromebooks and feel safe to get a chromebook

Member Van der Kloot - is this consistent?

Member Graham - it looks like we expect the students to sign off, but they can't

Ms. Laden - by way of a little background -this is the policy that parents sign out each year - it covers all devices, all uses - tech teachers review it with the students and students must sign off as well as have parental consent - the photos were utilized for classroom websites - it can easily be taken out - this other pieces have to be kept - reviewed in March of 2019 and passed by the school committee.

Mr. Murphy - I think this is an important point, even with this in place, we aren't refusing devices to anyone, the piece we have to consider is to create another waiver - to opt out of the privacy - you can pass it

Member Graham - I was just trying to clean it up - not worth our time next week for a band aid approach - strike the 2 sentences and let people know its no longer in the acceptable use policy - so they can feel comfortable to get a chromebook - and send it to the policy subcommittee

Mr. Murphy - So you are voting on a component of the policy

Motion for approval by Member Ruseau, Member Graham

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - motion passes

Condolences to the families of Joan Murray, Wayne Sargent & Joan Ahlstrom.

Motion to adjourn by Member Ruseau, seconded by Member McLaughlin

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - motion passes

Thank you everyone - meeting adjourned at 11:08 PM